on the borders of the Gobi desert. Ashvaghosa was a pious Buddhist and wrote also the *Buddha Charita*, a life of the Buddha, which was well known and had long been popular in India and China and Tibet. The Chinese translation, made in a past age, was by an Indian scholar.

These discoveries have given a new perspective to the history of the old Indian drama and it may be that further discoveries and finds will throw more light on this fascinating development of Indian culture. For, as Sylvain Levi has written in his 'Le Theatre Indien': 'Le theatre est la plus haute expression de la civilisation qui l'enfante. Qu'il traduise ou qu'il interprete la vie reelle, il est tenu de la resumer sous une forme frappante, ddgagee des accessoires insignificants, generalisee dans un symbole. L'originalite de 1'Inde s'est exprimee tout e n t i r e dans son art dramatique; elle y a combine et condense ses dogmes, ses doctrines, ses i n s t i t u t i o n s . . . . '

Europe first learned of the old Indian drama from Sir William Jones's translation of Kalidasa's 'Shakuntala', published in 1789. Something in the nature of a commotion was created among European intellectuals by this discovery and several edi-